

Wassim Guerfali

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Education

Alma College (Alma, Michigan)

Bachelor of Science

Anticipated Graduation: 2027

Majors: Economics and Mathematics

Economics Major GPA: 3.93 / 4.00 | Cumulative GPA: 3.50 / 4.00

Relevant Coursework: Econometrics, Applied Statistical Methods, Calculus I–II, Differential Equations

Mathematical Structures, Discrete Mathematics, Financial Mathematics; Linear Algebra and Multivariable Calculus (in progress)

Research Experience

Senior Thesis in Economics | Alma College, Department of Economics

2026 – Current

Michigan's Act 51 Road Funding Formula and County Pavement Condition - Advisor: Dr. Hinkel

- Designing and executing an independent study of whether the funding Act 51's condition-blind formula sent to counties actually improves pavement, using a segment-level first-difference design on Michigan's biennial pavement surveys.
- The dependent variable is the two-year change in International Roughness Index on roughly 7,000 matched road segments; the independent variable is cumulative Act 51 funding per county lane-mile, lagged to each survey window
- Estimated by OLS with window fixed effects and controls for baseline condition, truck and total AADT, segment geometry, and the county characteristics that drive the allocation formula; standard errors clustered by county and corroborated by wild cluster bootstrap given the small cluster count
- Built a Python pipeline (pdfplumber, Tesseract OCR, pandas) converting MDOT's monthly Act 51 County Continuation Sheets into a county-month panel of 2,988 county-months, with an internal reconciliation audit against printed county totals
- Constructed the dependent variable from MDOT's GIS road network as a lane-mile-weighted pavement condition measure, filtering a rolling live snapshot into clean annual cross-sections
- Spatially joined 24,500 AADT traffic count segments to county boundaries (24,499 matched) to construct traffic control variables under two weighting approaches
- Completed a 24-source literature review situating the work in the public finance and infrastructure investment literature.

Research Assistant and Co-Author | Alma College

2026 – Current

Construction Cost and Project Timeliness Study - with Dr. Hinkel and Larissa Petrucci

- Co-authoring a multi-institution study of construction cost and project timeliness in Santa Clara County, California, extending a prior county-level policy report
- Created a data extraction workstream, converting electronic certified payroll records (eCPRs) from public infrastructure projects into worker-level datasets capturing unique worker, craft, and total hours
- Designed the aggregation schema linking per-project worker counts to a master dataset of contractor composition, trade presence, and apprenticeship hours as a share of total hours

Undergraduate Research Assistant | Alma College, Department of Economics

2026 – Current

Faculty Supervisor: Dr. Vinitha Rachel Varghese

- Extracted and merged county-level Social Security (OASDI) benefits data from federal administrative sources into analysis-ready panel datasets
- Built reproducible data pipelines for faculty research, documenting extraction logic so results could be independently verified

Honors and Awards

Alma College: P-Global Fellowship

2025

Received a highly competitive fellowship of \$6,300 to support an international experience in India.

Received a highly competitive fellowship of \$6,100 to support a 6-month internship as a Junior Trade Commissioner

National Model United Nations | New York, NY

2024 - Current

Received the Outstanding Delegation Award, the highest recognition at the conference for three consecutive years.

Business Professionals of America | Orlando, FL 2025
1st Place National Award – Office Procedures
Certificate of High Achievement – Financial Math and Analysis Concepts
Certificate of High Achievement – Digital Marketing Concepts

Activities and Internships

Consulate General of Canada in Detroit | Detroit, MI 2025

Junior Trade Commissioner - Intern

- Researched U.S. companies to support investment attraction efforts, including gathering background, financial, and CRM data for business outreach and site proposal development
- Created social media content, supported trade shows and high-level visits, and vetted local service providers for reliability and relevance
- Maintained and expanded a database of 1,600 Canadian small businesses on a Consulate-developed platform, improving the accuracy of company and product information to enhance visibility among U.S. investors.

Shiv Nadar School | Delhi, India 2024

Mentoring Intern

- Taught 180 high school students about critical global issues, focusing on United Nations efforts
- Developed and led 3 Model United Nations conferences

Alma College: Model United Nations Team 2026 – Current

Head of the Position Paper editing Committee

Alma College: The International Club 2024 – Current

Skills / Language Proficiency

Programming and Statistical Software:

- R (data analysis, statistical modeling, regression analysis, visualization)
- Python (pdfplumber, pandas - automated data extraction from unstructured government documents)
- Stata

Methods: first-difference panel designs, cluster-robust and wild bootstrap inference, spatial joins and GIS data processing, administrative data construction

Arabic – Native Proficiency

French – Bilingual Proficiency

English – Bilingual Proficiency

Work Experience

Alma College: Residence Life 2026 – Current

Resident Assistant

- Live-in staff member responsible for approximately 30 residents; first point of contact for facilities issues, roommate mediation, and after-hours situations
- Handle sensitive student matters under confidentiality requirements

Alma College: Student Success Department 2024 – Current

International Students' Assistant

- Guided incoming international students with their legal document procedures

Alma College: Admissions Department 2024 – Current

Tour Guide

Leadership and Service

Delta Gamma Tau Fraternity 2024 – Current

Vice President

Secretary

- Organized a volunteering event to prepare 13,500 meals for families in need